EAP 401 COURSEWORK ESSAY TASK SHEET: Semester 1, 2025

This assignment will be evaluated by both the convenor of Module CNMSC1571 (Yuqian Wan) and myself, the convenor of. CNEAP 401. The mark awarded for CNEAP 401 will constitute 30% of the overall module grade.

MARKING RESPONSIBILITIES

Yuqian Wan (CNMSC1571) will assess the essay with a focus on subject knowledge and academic content. This includes evaluating:

- The accurate application of key theoretical frameworks from the module
- The synthesis of relevant academic literature
- The depth of critical thinking
- The quality and relevance of analysis related to the HM Passport Office case study
- The overall coherence and academic rigour of the argument from a subject perspective

Michael Warrick (CNEAP 401) will assess the quality of academic English and communication, including:

- Clarity and accuracy of written expression
- Use of an appropriate academic tone and vocabulary
- Essay structure and paragraph organisation
- Effective summarising and paraphrasing techniques
- Logical flow of ideas and cohesion
- Proper citation and referencing using the Lancaster Harvard style

This division of responsibility ensures that the assignment develops both critical subject-specific critical thinking and strong academic communication skills, reinforcing the integrated goals of both CNMSC1571 and CNEAP 401.

SHARED CNEAP 401 / CNMSC1571 ASSIGNMENT BRIEF AND GUIDELINES

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF

This assignment centres on the case study of Her Majesty's Passport Office (HMPO), which has been previously examined and discussed during class sessions. The case was analyzed through a series of questions explored in Seminar 1 in Module CNMSC1571. For this assignment, you are required to address a more specific, theoretically driven essay question.

Analyze the causes of the HM Passport Office crisis in June 2014.

Your essay must reference at least four of the following six sources:

1. Slack *et al.* (2022): This source introduces the "Four Vs" - Volume, Variety, Variation in demand, and Visibility - as a framework for analysing operational challenges and complexities within organisations such as HM Passport Office.

2. Slack *et al.* (2016): Building on core concepts in operations management, this edition provides insights into strategic operations choices and their consequences, offering a broader context for operational crises.

3. DaSilveira and Slack (2001): This article explores the inherent trade-offs organisations face when designing operations strategies, such as balancing cost efficiency with flexibility or responsiveness - issues directly relevant to the HMPO crisis.

4. Fisher (1997): Fisher's work examines how the alignment between product (or service) characteristics and supply chain strategy impacts performance, highlighting the risks of misalignment in public sector settings.

5. Syal (2014): This contemporary piece provides journalistic coverage and context on the HM Passport Office crisis, detailing the sequence of events, stakeholder perspectives, and immediate public response.

6. Spring (2020): This source offers critical reflections on the broader systemic and policy lessons drawn from public sector operational failures, providing a theoretical lens for evaluating the HMPO situation.

Be sure to link the main points of your arguments to the key ideas from your sources. You should take the key concepts, apply them, and write about the link between theory and practice in an appropriate and effective way.

GUIDELINES

Submission and Formatting

- Ensure that the document is **anonymised**, but make sure you include your **student I.D.** on the cover page.
- Indicate the word-count on the cover page.
- The essay should be 800-1000 words in length, plus any figures and/or tables.

- Insert page numbers at the bottom of each page.
- Please use Times New Roman or Arial font in either 11-point or 12-point size.
- Use 1.5 or double line spacing.

Figures and Tables

- The inclusion of figures and/or tables is optional for this essay.
- Each figure and table should be clearly numbered and titled and must be explicitly mentioned within the paragraph (i.e. not just appear).
- Do not reproduce any figures or tables; only use them if you have adapted them and synthesised different elements.

Citation and Referencing:

- Use Lancaster University Harvard referencing system as detailed on the– information on how to do this is widely available via the CNMSCI571 and CNEAP401 Moodle pages.
- Include a reference list at the end of the essay.
- Every citation must have a corresponding reference and vice versa.
- Use summarising and paraphrasing effectively. Direct quotations should not exceed 10% of the total word count.

Essay Structure and Content

- Academic Style: Use an appropriate academic tone and structure throughout.
- Your essay must be original work which is not copied in whole or in part from another source.

Introduction

- Provide general background and introduce the topic's relevance.
- Include a clear thesis statement that reflects the essay title and paraphrases it appropriately.
- You may include any relevant definitions or limitations.

Main Body

- Organise your ideas clearly, with each paragraph starting with a suitable topic sentence.
- Your analysis should explain the reasons behind the HMPO) crisis in June, 2014.

Conclusion

- Summarise your key points.
- End with a recommendation, prediction, or implication related to your discussion.

Do Not:

- Use subheadings
- Use bullet points
- Submit a report instead of an essay
- Write short paragraphs (fewer than 3–4 sentences)

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES EXCLUSIVE TO CNEAP 401

- Essay assigned: Week 6
- Draft submission: Week 8 (date to be confirmed). Ensure your draft submission is uploaded by 23:59 on the specified date.
- Final submission: Week 10 (date to be confirmed).
- Submit as a Word document on the EAP 401 Moodle page. Do not submit PDFs. SUBMISSIONS CANNOT BE ACCEPTED VIA WECHAT OR EMAIL
- Include the EAP 4O1 essay cover page at the beginning of the document, showing your student number, class number and date.
- Penalties for late submission:
    - More than 24 hours late: 5%
    - More than 36 hours late: 10%

*IMPORTANT: Only those students who can provide a doctor's note may request exemption from penalties.